

Cartographer's Review Portfolio

Curator's Question

Can you prove you understand exploration, tools, and maps well enough to open the next museum room?

ENTER THE MUSEUM

Portfolio Day in the Review Chamber

Yesterday, you filled in the evidence wall.

Today the museum board wants your

portfolio — organized proof that you understand exploration, tools, and maps.

The museum board left a note:

"Before we can open the World Map Hall, we need proof. Assemble a Cartographer's Review Portfolio."

*There's a curtain covering a doorway at the far end of the room.
What's behind it?*

INSERT IMAGE

Museum review chamber with a large portfolio desk, a curtained mysterious doorway at the far end, board note pinned to the door

VIRTUE SPOTLIGHT

Courage

*Putting together a portfolio takes courage.
You have to look at everything you've learned
and decide what matters most.*

It's okay if you don't remember every detail —
what counts is that you try to explain what you do know.

DISCOVER

What Goes in a Portfolio?

A portfolio is like a folder of your best work — not just facts, but things you can do.

Section 1**Evidence Skills**

Curator Training Hall

Sorted primary from secondary sources
Asked good questions before making claims
Studied sources carefully

Section 2**Exploration Knowledge**

Exploration Wing

Why people explored
What tools they used
Consequences: helpful and harmful

Section 3**Map Skills**

Great Map Room

Titles, compass roses, scales, legends
Cardinal directions
Map types and scale

YOUR TURN

Pause and Think

CHAT FRAME

"Which section feels strongest for you — evidence skills, exploration knowledge, or map skills?"

"Which one do you want to practice more?"

"Think for 30 seconds, then share with a partner."

PARTNER SHARE

My strongest section is _____ because...

I want to practice _____ more because...

INSERT IMAGE

Three portfolio folders color-coded: blue (evidence), green (exploration), purple (maps)

REVIEW

Portfolio Section 1: Evidence Skills

What is a primary source?

Something made during the time it describes — like a photo, a letter, or a map from that time period.

What is a secondary source?

Something written after the event, based on primary sources — like a textbook or biography.

KEY SKILL: You learned to look at sources carefully, sort them, and ask good questions before making claims.

CHAT FRAME

"How does knowing the difference between primary and secondary sources help a curator?"

REVIEW

Portfolio Section 2: Exploration Knowledge

Why did people explore?

They wanted to find trade routes, claim new land, spread ideas, or discover things nobody had seen before.

What is one consequence of exploration?

Explorers found new places and trade routes, but they also took land from people who already lived there.

What tools did explorers use?

Compass: pointed north so sailors knew their direction | Astrolabe: measured star positions to determine location | Maps: helped plan routes and record discoveries

CHAT FRAME

"If you were an explorer, which tool would you want most? Why?"

REVIEW

Portfolio Section 3: Map Skills

What does a compass rose show?

It shows directions on a map — north, south, east, west, and the directions in between.

Why do maps need a legend?

A legend explains what the symbols on a map mean, so anyone can read and understand it.

How does map scale help?

Scale tells you how distances on the map compare to real distances, so you know how far apart places really are.

INSERT IMAGE

A simple map with labeled elements: title at top, compass rose in corner, legend box, scale bar

THEN AND NOW

Portfolios: Then and Now

SOCRATIC QUESTIONS

- What stayed the same about why people collect their best work?

INSERT IMAGE

Split image: Left shows a leather portfolio case carried by an old mapmaker. Right shows a student's digital portfolio on a tablet screen.

THEN: A portfolio was a large leather case that artists and mapmakers carried to show their work.

NOW: Students and workers use portfolios on paper or on a computer to show their best thinking.

EXHIBIT LABEL

The Big Picture

EXHIBIT LABEL

A good Exhibit Reviewer can look at evidence from different topics and explain how they connect. Exploration, tools, and maps are not three separate ideas — they are parts of one story about how people learned to understand the world.

OPTI SAYS

I heard the museum board is very picky about portfolios. But you know what? You've been doing this work for weeks. You already have the evidence — now you just have to organize it and explain it clearly. I believe in you!

DISCUSS

Why Does a Portfolio Matter?

SOCRATIC QUESTIONS

- *Why does the museum board want a portfolio and not just a test?*
- *What makes a portfolio different from just memorizing facts?*
- *What is the strongest claim we can make from the evidence we have gathered?*

CHAT FRAME

"Turn to a partner: What's the most important thing you'd put in your portfolio?"

INSERT IMAGE

Museum board members examining a student portfolio with magnifying glasses, impressed expressions

GUIDED PRACTICE

Let Me Show You

Watch how I answer an evidence question

Q: What is one evidence skill you learned in the Curator Training Hall? How does it help a curator?

TEACHER MODEL

I learned to sort primary and secondary sources before making a claim. ← *names the skill*

This helps a curator because they need to know if evidence came from the actual time period or was written later. ←
explains how it helps

NOTICE: I named a specific skill AND explained how it helps. Both parts matter.

WE TRY TOGETHER

Let's Write One Together

Q: Name one tool explorers used and explain how it helped them.

CHAT FRAME

"Which tool should we pick — compass, astrolabe, or a map?"

"What did that tool actually do for explorers? Let's be specific."

INSERT IMAGE

*Compass, astrolabe, and old navigation map
illustrated side by side*

OUR ANSWER

[Teacher writes class response here as students contribute ideas]

YOUR TURN

Now You Try

Practice writing a portfolio-quality answer on your own

PROMPT

Why is it important for a map to have a title, compass rose, and legend?

Think about what happens when someone tries to read a map that's missing these parts.

SENTENCE STARTERS

- A map needs a title because...
- Without a compass rose, a reader would not know...
- A legend is important because it shows...

INSERT IMAGE

Student writing in notebook, broken map on one side vs complete map on the other

ERROR ANALYSIS

Spot the Mistake

Which portfolio answer has a problem? Why?

ANSWER A

"I learned about explorers and maps. They used stuff to help them. Maps are good because they show things."

Problem: Too vague. No specific tool, no specific map element, no example.

ANSWER B

"Explorers used compasses to figure out which direction they were going. Then mapmakers added compass roses to maps so readers could understand directions too."

Strong: Names a specific tool, connects it to a map element, shows the link.

KEY: The museum board wants specific details and clear connections — not vague summaries.

SELF-CHECK

Quick Self-Check

Not graded — just for you!

1. What makes something a primary source?

It was made during the time it describes.

2. How are exploration and maps connected?

Explorers found new places, and mapmakers recorded them.

3. What is a portfolio?

A collection of your best evidence, organized to show what you know.

ASSIGNMENT

Your Portfolio Evidence Questions

1 What is one evidence skill you learned in the Curator Training Hall? How does it help a curator?

Think about how you studied sources, asked questions, or sorted evidence.

2 Name one tool explorers used and explain how it helped them.

Pick a tool from the Exploration Wing — compass, astrolabe, or a map they used to navigate.

3 Why is it important for a map to have a title, compass rose, and legend?

Think about what happens when someone tries to read a map that's missing these parts.

CURATOR TASK

Portfolio Synthesis

CURATOR TASK: PORTFOLIO SYNTHESIS

Write your portfolio statement for the museum board.

The museum board wants to know: What have you learned, and how does it all connect? Write 3–4 sentences explaining what you know about exploration, tools, and maps. Use at least one example from what you've studied.

Explain what you've learned and how exploration, tools, and maps are connected. Give at least one example.

CURATOR'S CHRONICLE

In this exhibit, I learned that ____ because ____.

SUBMIT

Turn-In Checklist

☐ I answered all three evidence questions.

☐ I completed the Portfolio Synthesis.

☐ I wrote my Curator's Chronicle.

☐ I copied or downloaded my work and submitted to Canvas.

INSERT IMAGE

*Clipboard with checkmarks,
portfolio folder with a gold seal*

LESSON 3.04.02 COMPLETE

The World Map Hall Awaits!

Your portfolio is complete. The museum board says the World Map Hall can open!

COMING NEXT

But when the curtain comes down, you see a huge wall map of the world — and it's missing everything. No continent labels. No ocean names. No landforms.

The World Geography Curators have a big job ahead — and that's you, starting next lesson.